

TECHNICAL REPORT WRITING

Week 3

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Defining the objectives(purpose)

WHAT IS AN OBJECTIVE?

- A specific result that a person or system aims to achieve within a time frame and with available resources.
- In general, **objectives** are more specific and easier to measure than goals.
- **Objectives** are basic tools that underlie all planning and strategic activities.

DEFINING THE OBJECTIVES

- Defining the objectives of your communication are extremely important.
- **Defining objectives** has a strong link with the **audience analysis** covered in the last lecture.
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- It is important to know the nature of the audience whether they are **Technical** of **non Technical**.(who the audience is?)
- And important to know what are we writing?

WHAT IS THE PURPOSE OF WRITING A DOCUMENT

- What is the

Purpose

of writing a document



WHAT IS THE PURPOSE OF WRITING A DOCUMENT

- Why we need document?
- How we write the particular document?
- Types of documents purposes
- Explicit Purposes
- Implicit Purposes

EXPLICIT PURPOSES

- Documents should be created for explicit purposes or goals that both the writer and the reader would readily agree on.
- Explicit purposes means that are clearly stated.
- They should be clear and always to reader

EXPLICIT PURPOSES OF WRITING A DOCUMENT.

- Although there are many explicit purposes for creating a scientific or technical document , but there are four general categories:

- 1. To provide information**
- 2. To give instructions**
- 3. To persuade the reader**
- 4. To enact (or prohibit something)**

I.TO PROVIDE INFORMATION

- **DOCUMENT TYPES**

- Literature Reviews
- Specifications

- **SECTION IN DOCUMENT**

- Background
- Theory
- Materials
- Results
- Tables

EXAMPLE

“The document will discuss the reasons behind the construction of new Trade Center in Islamabad”

- ❑ This is starting the purpose of the document at begging
- ❑ So it showing that the document will have some kind of information that will be given to users

2.TO GIVE INSTRUCTIONS

- **DOCUMENT TYPE**

- Instructions

- **SECTION IN DOCUMENT**

- Procedure
- Work plans

EXAMPLE

“The document outline a procedure for constructing a new Trade Center in Islamabad”

- ❑ It is very clear that the procedure is going to be talk about.
- ❑ Writer not giving the general information but talking about the **specific procedure.(instructions)**

3.TO PERSUADE THE READER

- **DOCUMENT TYPE**

- Proposals
- Recommendation reports
- Job application letters
- resumes

There are different formats and sections but the purpose is only to persuade the reader

- **SECTION IN DOCUMENT**

- Discussion
- Conclusion
- Recommendations

EXAMPLE

“The document proposes a feasibility study for constructing a new Trade Center in Islamabad”

- ☐ It is very clear to defining the objective of the document which is feasibility study.
- ☐ You are making feasibility to persuade yourself or investirs

3.TO ENACT SOMETHING

- **DOCUMENT TYPE**

- Acceptance Letters
- Regulations
- Patents
- Authorizations Memoranda

- **Not have many sections, more concise and more to the point.**

- **Documents that are used to enact something are generally shorter.**
- **Generally giving instructions to do something or not to do something.**

EXAMPLE

NOTICE: Construction site for trade center ahead; No unauthorized person is allowed.

- ❑ This is very direct, very clear notice which is prohibiting something.

IMPLICIT PURPOSES

These were some specific **explicit** purposes of documents.

Now lets have a look on **implicit** purposes of documents.

IMPLICIT PURPOSES

- Keep your implicit goals in your mind when writing a document.
- In addition to explicit goals , writer almost always wire with other unstated but still extremely important implicit goals.
- Common goals are to established a relationship to create trust and established credibility, and to document action.
- Relation ship depends upon communication
- These implicit goals are never write in the documents but they are still there with explicit goals.



RELATIONSHIP



- **A well written letter of inquiry may begin a professional may last for years.**
 - (inquiry starts and never ends on startup of a long answers and questions session)
- **Readers establishes a relationship with the research paper authors.**
 - Many time when a reader reads a research paper and the he might want to ask some questions so the author correspondence become very fluid full and long listing research oriented relationship.
 - It is not important that the all documentations are addressed directly with audience

Trust And credibility



- Why it is important to create a trust and create credibility with audience.
- The goal of all technical or scientific writings is to get the readers trust and credibility.
- If reader have no trust on writer , then writer faces difficulty to write
- It needs more explanations for a specific talk to ensure the authenticity to the reader.

TRUST

- So add authentic information's in a document
- You should carefully qualify the statements that need to be qualify(discussion and explanations)
- If you are supposing then not write it as claim.
- If readers doubt your ability then your document will no longer effective
- Speech is not as permanent as written communication is.
- Deadlines , records, experimental results, property rights OF IDEA etc.

WHAT IS THE

IMPORTANCE

Of the Statement of
the purposes



STATEMENT OF PURPOSE

- We states the statement of the purpose or objective of a document at the beginning.
- Researchers are technical readers or busy people so it will alert them to read the document or not.
- So that busy readers will attracted and want to read the docoment.
- **Statement/objective/introduction/abstract**

EXAMPLE

“This letter is written to ensure that management is fully aware of the seriousness of the current erosion problem in the section 3 from an engineering standpoint.”

- ☐ Reader will know the seriousness of the report or letter after reading this statement..
- ☐ You are making feasibility to persuade yourself or investors

HOW DO YOU ACTUALLY GO ABOUT

DEFINING

Your Objectives



EXAMPLE

“Consider the example of ALI who is graduated from FAST, who has been appointed as junior. SE in ADAM Soft.”

OBJECTIVES

- Today Ali boss dropped by and asked him that the two vice presidents of Adam Soft have asked Ali for a report on his progress.
- **Ali must now decide what he has to write in the report.**
- If writes his objectives clearly and precisely , they can guide him through all his work at writing

EXAMPLE

Who are Audience?

Two voice presidents of Adam Soft

What are Objectives?

Now clear the objectives (Acceptance of your proposal)

The readers Feel & Think should be positive

WHY IS THE **IDENTIFICATION**



Of final goal is important
While writing a document

GUIDELINE I (SHORT OBJECTIVES)

- When defining your objectives, start by identifying the final result you want from your communication.
- Doing so will help you remember that when you write you are performing an action for your desired result / outcome
- Your short term objectives are based on final goal.

EXAMPLE OF GOALS

- You want your boss to approve that project you are describing in your proposal.
- You want two new people to assist you in the new project you have been assigned by your employer
- You want a new printer as sharing the old one while whole department reduces your efficiency.
- If you don't know the final goal of your report the you don't know the objective of that report

HOW DO PEOPLE **RESPOND**

When they read
something



RESPONDS

- Respond are
- Think
- Feel
- So present in a favorable way, feel the audience feelings and present in favorable way

WHY SHOULD YOU **IDENTIFY THE TASKS**

That would enable
your reader



GUIDELINE 2

ENABLING ELEMENTS

-
- Identify the tasks you will help your readers perform while they read
 - When you identify the tasks you are describing the enabling element of the purpose
 - At the general level all tasks are same for all readers
 - Is your message confusing the reader or clarifying him.

WHAT TASKS

READER PERFORM

While reading



READING TASKS

- Reader performs task of locating, understanding and using information in many ways , depending on solution.
- For example Ali's report would be read from front to back by the voice president.
- To prove, to reject, to transfer, to fired

IN THIS LECTURE YOU LEARN TO,

- Defining objectives.
- Document purpose.
- Implicit purpose.
- Explicit purpose.
- Why do we need document?

IN THIS LECTURE

- **YOU WILL LEARN**

1. Identify the tasks you will help your readers perform while they read
2. Tell how you want to change the readers attitude
3. Learn your readers important attitude
4. Learn who all your readers will be
5. Fill in a sample worksheet that should be kept in mind when defining objectives
6. Learn the importance of 'Appropriateness' in business and technical communication

I. IDENTIFY THE TASKS YOU WILL HELP YOUR READERS PERFORM WHILE THEY READ

- When you identify the tasks, you are describing the enabling element of purpose
- At a general level all tasks are the same for all readers

-
- Readers perform tasks of locating, understanding, and using information in many ways, depending on the situation
 - For example Ali's progress report would be read from front to back by the vice president

EXAMPLE

- Consider the example of AYESHA , an engineer employed by a steel mill.
- Her task is to study two type of furnaces and present a proposal to help the upper management decide which one to buy.

- **She has two option to present the immense amount information she has gather**
-

1. **Divided pattern**
2. **Alternating Pattern**

Divided Pattern	Divided Pattern
Furnace A	Furnace B
Cost	Cost
Efficiency	Efficiency
Construction	Construction
Time	Time
Air Pollution	Air Pollution

Alternating Pattern

Cost

Furnace A

Furnace B

Efficiency

Furnace A

Furnace B

Construction Time

Furnace A

Furnace B

Air Pollution

Furnace A

Furnace B

CHOOSE THE PROPER WAY OF WRITING

- Reader Centric Approach
- Writer Centric Approach
- She knows that the reader will compare the two furnaces on basis of different characteristics

PROPER WAY OF WRITING

- Identify the questions your reader will ask
- Then identify the strategy to answer all questions
- Finally identify the ways your reader will use your answers.

2. CONSIDER HOW YOU WANT YOUR COMMUNICATION TO ALTER THE READERS ATTITUDE

- Find Points between you and your reader.
- So being by identifying the attitude you want to alter
- Some time you will want to reinforce an existing attitude. (resume to update your image)
- For example you might aim your presentation so the reader feel more favorable impressed by your qualifications
- Company is right but you present it wrong
- Furnace I is good so white report wile pointing I

HOW TO SHAPE **READERS**

Attitude



POINT OF DISCUSSION

- Some time you are successive in your proposal or some time not...how?.
- You need to write more persuasive information in your report..
- So write a one more proposal or memo to change the readers thought....

The way things are	Your act (you write)	The way you want things to be
Your readers are bank clerks who will be using the computer system . They are afraid of the new systems and are therefore reluctant to use it..	You write a procedure manual that shows how easy it is to use the new system.	The bank clerks feel relaxed and self confident after learning how to use the new system from your procedure manual.

3. IDENTIFY AND LEARN ABOUT YOUR READERS IMPORTANT CHARACTERISTICS

- You might want to think of your readers in term of the following three roles
- Decision makers
- Advisors
- Implementers

LEARN YOUR READERS IMPORTANT CHARACTERISTICS

- **Decision Makers**

- The decision makers role is to say how the organization or some part will act when confronted with a particular situation.

- **Advisors**

- Advisors provides information and advice for the decision makers

- **Implementers**

- implementers carry out the decisions that have been made.

ARE THE READERS
FAMILIAR

With your topic



-
- Your readers familiarity with your topic will determine the amount of background information you will need to make your communication understandable to your audience.
 - Keep in mind that people unfamiliar to your topic will also want you to explain how the information relates to term.
 - Why we are reading, why need to read???
 - Clear on top the importance of report...

4. LEARN WHO ALL YOUR READERS WILL BE

1. **Phantom readers**
2. **Future readers**
3. **Complex readers**

PHANTOM READERS

- Those who may be happy with you.
- You write for decision makers but also reads by advisors

FUTURE READERS

- Your communication will be used for weeks months or years
- Read immediately and read again and again by future readers

5. WORKSHEET DEFINING

Objectives

- **Overall purpose**
 - What are you writing?
 - What promotes you to write?
 - What outcomes do you desire?

WORKSHEET DEFINING

Objectives

- **Reader Profile**

- Who is a primary reader?
- What is the readers relationship to you?
- What are your readers job title and responsibilities?
- Who else might read your communication?

WORKSHEET DEFINING

Objectives

- **Communication**
 - How familiar is the reader with your communication?
 - How familiar is the reader with your specialty?
 - Does your reader have communication preferences?

WORKSHEET DEFINING

NEEDS

- **Readers Information**

- What are the key questions your reader will ask while reading?
- How will your reader search for answers?
 - Sequential reading from beginning to end?
 - Selective reading , only looking for key terms?
 - Other(explain)

WORKSHEET DEFINING

NEEDS

- **How will the reader use the information you provided?**
 - Compare point by point?(what will be the point of comparison)
 - Attempt to determine how the information you provided will affect him?
 - Attempt to determine how the information you provided will affect org?
 - Follow instructions step by step
 - Other (explain)

WORKSHEET DEFINING

NEEDS

- **Readers Attitude**

- What is the readers attitude towards your subject?
- What is the readers attitude towards you?

A Work Sheet

OBJECTIVE

- What are you writing
- You are writing a proposal for your software company ADAM Soft should assign the international projects to the most reliable engineers.

OBJECTIVE

- What outcome you desired?
- Put into new effective output that what you proposed..

READER PROFILE

- Who will be your primary reader?
- Miss Zara Shaikh.
- What is the relationship of the reader to you?
- Formal relationship
- What is the job title of the reader?
- Project director of Adam Soft.
- Who else will read my information?
- Mr umair, mr usman, etc

READER PROFILE

- How familiar with your communication?
- She is the head of your assigned project and used the current system for three years.
- How familiar with your specialty?
- She is assigning the engineers from past three years so she know the way to assign.
- Your reader have communication preferences?
- Yes of course Zara has communication preferences and business styles she requires

READERS NEEDS

- **What are the key questions that readers required to ask?**
- What makes you think that something is wrong with the present system ?
- What will be the criteria for selecting a engineer for a appropriate project?
- What is a
- good engineer?
- How exactly the new system will works?
- Based on this proposal, what do I change?
- Now how readers search answers, start to end or key points or selective.

HOW THE READER READS THE INFORMATION YOU PROVIDED

- Will they compare only point by point?
- Yes, miss zara will compare the proposed system with existing system.
- Will the information you provided will effect her ?
- Yes if it is effective then it will effect the her current policies views
- Will the information you provided will effect org?
- Yes if it will effective on efficiency and cost then it will effect.
- Will she follow instructions step by step?
- Yes, I could be as you given some recommendations and she could be follow step by step.

READERS ATTITUDE

- What is readers attitude towards the proposal?
- Zara is new in organization, she is not in favor for new system as she feels it creates the competition among new employers, she is very happy with the present system and she does not want to change it so her attitude will not be favorable for your proposal.
- What is the readers attitude towards you?
- As she thinks if you are not expert in your topic in nerves and you are junior so you need more effort to acctptance

7. APPROPRIATENESS

- Make your document appropriate to your goals in writing it, your audience's purpose in reading it, and the specific institutional contexts in which it is written and read.
- Familiarity of your level of knowledge and your readers level of knowledge
- Just Like mathematical equation is not for managers.
- Follow intuitional culture, styles, templates, manuals.

END